

trust and love from the community has been humbling.

Sumit: What motivated me is the growing adoption of VDA among the Indians, their hunger for innovative products and belief in web3. At the same time, we have noticed a significant shift in perception around VDA, especially among policymakers. From being skeptical, policymakers have now begun to acknowledge the industry. Moving away from outright rejection, they are now showing interest in learning more about the technology and its potential applications. Measures such as FIU regulations indicate a positive step forward in this regard.

I often share within my team that we're not merely running a company; we're actively shaping an entire industry. As founding members of the Bharat Web3 Association (BWA), we recognize the significance of our role in laying the groundwork for a responsible Web3 future in India.

At CoinDCX, our mission has always been to create an inclusive ecosystem where individuals and businesses can fully participate in the crypto space. Moving forward, our focus remains unchanged - we're determined to support India's emergence as a global hub for Web3 innovation.

Q Do you foresee the crypto market taking a positive turn anytime soon?

Sumit: Certainly, history offers insight into the cyclical nature of the crypto market. Over time, we've observed fluctuations between periods of heightened activity and what's commonly referred to as "crypto winters." Presently, there are indications that we might be on the cusp of a significant shift, potentially heralding the onset of a bullish market phase.

This potential upswing holds considerable importance within the context of crypto history. Notably, there are three major catalysts aligning, each with the potential to fuel a bullish trajectory within a relatively short span. Firstly, the introduction of Bitcoin ETFs has garnered significant attention. ***Institutional endorsement will be a key driver propelling the crypto industry forward in 2024*** - this long-awaited assurance is anticipated to push the next level of adoption.

Secondly, the impending Bitcoin halving event holds historical significance, typically resulting in exponential price surges attributed to reduced supply and heightened demand. Lastly, the submission of a spot Ethereum ETF application to the US Securities and Exchange Commission by Franklin Templeton, an in-

stitution often associated with traditional finance, is noteworthy.

Q How have you seen the preferences and behaviors of crypto investors change over the past 4-5 years?

Sumit: There's been a significant rise in crypto adoption, with a growing number of investors showing interest in virtual digital assets. ***One key change is the maturation of these investors - the average age of investors has now increased to around 30 years old, indicating a more serious and committed approach to crypto investment.***

Another noticeable trend is the increasing interest in structured investment products such as systematic investment plans (SIPs) that offer structured accumulation of assets, providing avenues for sustained wealth growth within the crypto asset class.

Moreover, the overall narrative surrounding crypto in India is changing rapidly. What was once met with skepticism is now sparking curiosity among investors. This shift can be attributed to the tech-savvy nature of the younger generation and the availability of user-friendly investment platforms, which are making it easier for people to start their investment journey in crypto.

On the global level, institutional investments have increased multifold adding new capital to the industry, and this trend is bound to add further impetus to the retail investors.

Q What prompted you to look at a larger landscape? What opportunities exist in decentralized finance (DeFi) space?

Neeraj: We want to continue building Web3 products and solutions enabling any individual with a smart-

phone to take part in the Web3 economy and gain value from it. We solved the access problem for crypto assets via CoinDCX App. The key for the next big growth story lies in DeFi. DeFi has seen a 100x growth over the past two years and expected to see explosive growth in the next 2-3 years. However, to make it more accessible to non-VDA natives, there is huge scope for development in the DeFi space. Last year we launched our DeFi App Okto for the global users. We wanted to solve the access challenge for users for DeFi investment opportunities and make it almost as easy as any internet App they are already engaged with.

We have taken a step forward and are now supporting customer facing companies to onboard Web3 through the Okto Web3 Software Development Kit. Our vision is to touch upon every segment of society and build a better, more secure, and decentralized internet.

Sumit: Looking ahead, CoinDCX aims to solidify its position as a global leader in Web3 Finance. Our commitment to 'Fi' - finance, innovation, and inclusivity - serves as our guiding principle. We strive for excellence across the entire Web3 spectrum, bridging the realms of centralized exchange and DeFi. Through strategic initiatives and groundbreaking advancements, we aspire to become the gateway that propels the mass adoption of Web3 technologies.

Importantly, we acknowledge the extraordinary potential of India's tech talent to lead innovation and shape the future of Web3 on a global scale. By fostering a supportive ecosystem, removing barriers, and empowering the next generation of innovators, we aim to leverage India's abundant talent pool to drive forward innovation and propel the Web3 industry into the future.

